

generative AI technologies rapidly evolve to become powerful tools for information manipulation, capable of generating persuasive content and amplifying messaging, their implications for global information security are becoming more acute.

Responsible Military AI

Responsible Military AI refers to international and national frameworks and guidelines aimed at ensuring ethical and lawful development and use of AI in defence applications. It demands transparency, vigorous validation, establishing human interface during development and deployment, and responsibility for its use, ensuring reliability and security, accountability for outcomes, proactive risk mitigation of unintended biases or harms and adherence to laws of armed conflict.

History shows that humans will push science in new directions, regardless of whether some of those directions are dangerous. Left unchecked, the AI arms race could usher in weapons and modes of warfare that are more efficient and deadlier, but with less human oversight, and also lower the escalation threshold. The best time to share and collaborate on a dangerous technology is before trust erodes and an arms race begins. Equating AI with nuclear technology for control and regulation (like the Treaty on the Non-Proliferation of Nuclear Weapons) is misplaced, since there are major differences to do with issues of inspection, verification, rapid and unpredictable pace of technology development and involvement of private players.

Avoiding an AI arms race requires a combination of international collaboration, assurance mechanisms and a focus on responsible innovation and governance to build shared standards and trust. Success of any global agreement will hinge on assurance mechanisms that allow parties to verify compliance with agreements. An effective assurance regime would need to prevent, and not just deter, rule violations. There have been attempts at bilateral and multilateral collaboration between countries and stakeholders for regulating AI, including in defence, with militaries recognising the need to build safeguards to avoid miscalculations that can lead to serious consequences. Many countries have articulated strategies and approach to responsible military AI, through policy frameworks and guidelines. However, much more needs to be done; stakeholders must act collectively and decisively to ensure that the AI arms race is not allowed to move faster than regulations can keep up.

The AI regulatory approach presents a dilemma. While providing a framework for responsible AI development, it risks stifling innovation and preventing nations from advancing in this ground-breaking technolo-

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